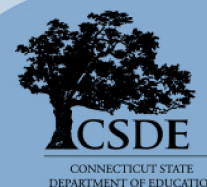


DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



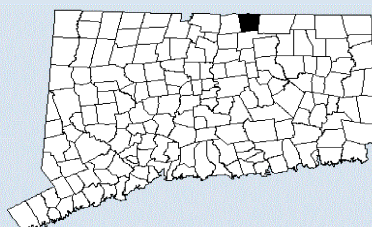
Somers School District

Mr. Brian Czapla, Superintendent • 860-749-2270 • <http://www.somers.k12.ct.us/>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	4
Enrollment	1,305
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$17,794
Total Expenditures ¹	\$24,716,201

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.4
Male	659	50.5	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	17	1.3	5.2
Black or African American	39	3.0	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	58	4.4	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	19	1.5	4.0
White	1,169	89.6	49.9
English Learners	*	*	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	60	4.6	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	207	15.9	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	45	6.9	*	*
Male	66	10.1	*	*
Black or African American	14	36.8	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	15	25.0	*	*
White	76	6.6	11	0.9
English Learners	*	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	37	35.2	6	5.4
Students with Disabilities	43	19.9	7	2.9
District	111	8.5	14	1.0
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 68

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Somers School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	109.1
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	4.8
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	17.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	34.4
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	3.0
School Level	6.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	2.0
Support Staff	1.5
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	4.6
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	11.0
School Nurses	5.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	62.2

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.3
Black or African American	1	0.6	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	2	1.3	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.1
White	153	98.1	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	7.5	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	0	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	0	*	*	*
White	41	42.7	77	74.8
English Learners	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	0	*	*	*
Students with Disabilities	*	*	12	54.5
District	45	41.3	85	70.8
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	9	*
Emotional Disturbance	*	*
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	62	95.4
Other Health Impairment	60	80.0
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	24	92.3
District	162	83.1
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Somers School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	16	1.2	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	*	*	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.5
Learning Disability	65	5.0	5.8
Other Health Impairment	76	5.8	3.3
Other Disabilities	9	0.7	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	29	2.2	1.9
All Disabilities	204	15.6	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	*	*	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	*	*	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$15,946,779	\$11,481	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$1,709,353	\$1,267	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$634,915	\$471	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$581,477	\$431	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$1,337,993	\$992	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$326,748	\$242	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$2,779,539	\$2,060	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$1,111,536	\$842	\$1,159
Food services	.	.	\$21
Enterprise operations	\$287,861	\$213	\$151
Total	\$24,716,201	\$17,794	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$1,870,739	36.5	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$828,341	16.2	11.1
Other Salaries	\$283,589	5.5	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$622,818	12.2	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$136,260	2.7	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$889,904	17.4	22.5
Supplies	\$34,232	0.7	0.5
Property Services	.	.	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$449,044	8.8	7.2
Equipment	\$8,096	0.2	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$405	0.0	0.1
Total	\$5,123,429	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		20.7	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	72.9
State	25.4
Federal	1.6
Tuition & Other	0.1

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Somers School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Somers School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	6	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	8	*
English Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	18	*
Students with Disabilities	14	*
District	106	94.3
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	80.7	55	50.5
Male	74.2	56	46.7
Black or African American	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	*	*	*
White	78.9	102	51.3
English Learners	N/A	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*	*
Students with Disabilities	55.6	*	*
District	77.3	111	48.5
State	85.0		36.0

³ College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴ Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2021 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	73.5	92.3
Male	70.4	91.3
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	71.3	91.5
English Learners	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	71.8	91.8
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Somers School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	8.5%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	22.5%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	56.8%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	48.5%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		20.9%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		94.3%	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		91.7%	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		71.8%	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		71.4%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	91.7%	2.3%	9.8%	N

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Somers School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Somers Public Schools engages in a continuous cycle of reflection and improvement. The curriculum development process, instructional initiatives, and professional development support the development of effective learning environments. The Pupil Services Department is continuously improving programs and services by staying current on trends, streamlining the PPT process, ensuring all stakeholders have the relevant information in a timely fashion and reorganizing the caseloads of related services providers to improve our responsiveness. Student progress is assessed via iReady Diagnostics universal screen testing for grades 1-8, and any high school student utilizing intervention services. Primary students are also assessed using a variety of universal assessments. The Somers Elementary School (SES) staff prides itself on its communication with parents and families. In addition to classroom and school newsletters sent out monthly, teachers utilize the Remind app, and SchoolMessenger is used district-wide to keep parents informed. Parents can meet with building administrators to ask questions or share concerns. Each school year starts with Meet and Greet. Students and parents come in the day before school begins to meet their teachers and see their classrooms. Parents are encouraged to utilize the Home and School Communication link on the school webpage and electronic signage at the entrance of the school for information about school events and policies. During normal times, Somers Elementary School also conducts an annual Open House, Curriculum Night, and Grade 5 Technology Night. Mabelle B. Avery Middle School (MBA) has a rich tradition of supporting the family's role in education. The Team Leader Council meets bi-monthly to discuss climate, Common Core, assessment, budget, and technology. The annual Open House helps parents support the developmental changes seen in middle school. The orientation program increases parental understanding of expectations in a middle school and assures a smooth transition for 6th-grade students. The Somers High School (SHS) advisory program continues to evolve and improve based on feedback and student needs. The alternative education (ASPIRE) program addresses the needs of students who are not experiencing success in traditional high school. The ASPIRE program utilizes Odysseyware, an online learning program that supports students' specific learning needs.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Somers participates in and is committed to the Project Choice program. Also, we had several cultural arts programs to increase cultural awareness. To raise students' awareness of diverse economic needs, SES participated in the Grade 3 food drive donating to the Somers Food Pantry. The Grade 5 Giving Tree event donated proceeds to a local charity, and the Mitten Tree donates hats and mittens to local children in need. Students learn the importance of community service to others through these charitable events. Mabelle B. Avery students are required to take a World Language each year. Students learn about the cultures of French or Spanish speaking countries through international food days, a celebration of national holidays, and cultural activities. One of the school's most popular after-school programs is the Service and Volunteer Effort Club. The club members raised money and performed volunteer work for local charities. The club conducted annual food drives, donating collected items to a local food pantry. A West African Music Dance and Culture workshop for 7th grade continued to be an integral part of the school year. Somers High School's participation in Project Choice assures funds are secured to support participation in activities such as prom, senior banquet, senior outing, athletics, and drama. Project Choice students and local students received assistance with participation fees. After hours transportation was also provided, so students were not dependent upon private vehicles to get them home. The Gay-Straight Alliance and The Diversity Club continued to be active clubs. They sponsored a variety of events to promote awareness and the embracing of the diversity among the SHS community. The students' met with their advisor regularly, and the advisor is a member of the Safe School Climate Committee.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Somers School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Somers Board of Education provides equitable funding to meet the needs of the students. The district is comprised of three schools: one elementary (K-5), one middle (6-8), and one high school (9-12). Enrollment figures at each building are monitored to ensure adequate staffing and resources. The curriculum revision cycle provides each content area an opportunity to purchase updated curriculum materials regularly. Also, the administrative team meets regularly to develop and revise long-range plans to ensure the equitable allocation of resources among schools. All schools have intervention teams to streamline the intervention process and assessments. Students are identified for work with intervention teachers or tutors to support their learning needs. At the beginning of the budget cycle, each school presents the budget and programmatic needs to the Superintendent. A budget is constructed based on the identified needs and the District's Strategic Plan. The Superintendent's proposed budget is then presented to the Board of Education for further refinement.